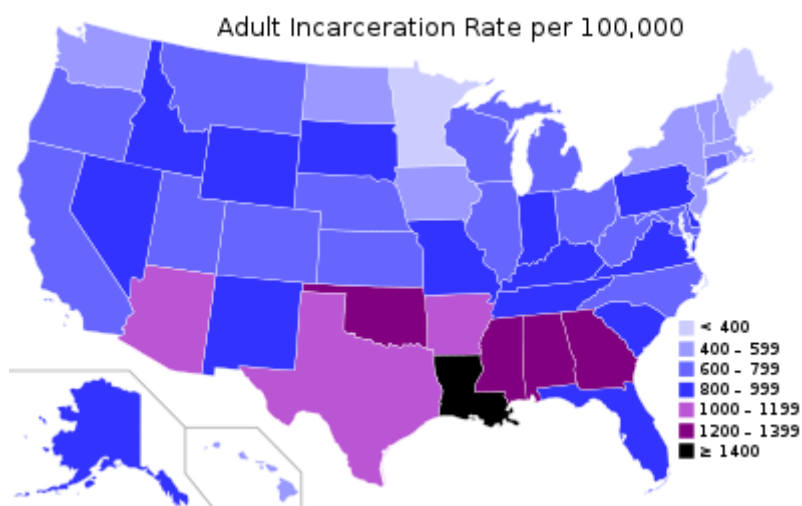


United States incarceration rate

This article focuses on the incarceration rate. For a discussion of incarcerations more generally, see [Incarceration in the United States](#).

In September 2013, the incarceration rate of the United States of America was the highest in the world at 716 per 100,000 of the national population; by 2019 it had fallen to 419 in state and federal prisons per 100,000.^[1] Between 2019 and 2020, the United States saw a significant drop in the total number of incarcerations. State and federal prison and local jail incarcerations dropped by 14% from 2.1 million in 2019 to 1.8 million in mid-2020.^[2] While the United States represents about 4.2 percent of the world's population,^[3] it houses around 20 percent of the world's prisoners.^[4] Corrections (which includes prisons, jails, probation, and parole) cost around \$74 billion in 2007 according to the [U.S. Bureau of Justice Statistics](#) (BJS).^{[5][6]} According to the *Justice Expenditures and Employment in the United States, 2017* report release by BJS, it's estimated that county and municipal governments spent roughly US\$30 billion on corrections in 2017.^{[7][8]}



A map of U.S. states by adult incarceration rate per 100,000 adult population. State prisons and local jails. Excludes federal prisoners.

As of their March 2020 publication, the [Prison Policy Initiative](#), a non-profit organization for [decarceration](#), estimated that in the United States, about 2.3 million people were or are currently incarcerated. Of those who were incarcerated, 1,291,000 people were in state prison, 631,000 in local jails, 226,000 in federal prisons, 44,000 in youth correctional facilities, 42,000 in immigration detention camps, 22,000 in involuntary commitment, 11,000 in territorial prisons, 2,500 in Indian Country jails, and 1,300 in United States military prisons.^[9]

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References

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Prison and jail population

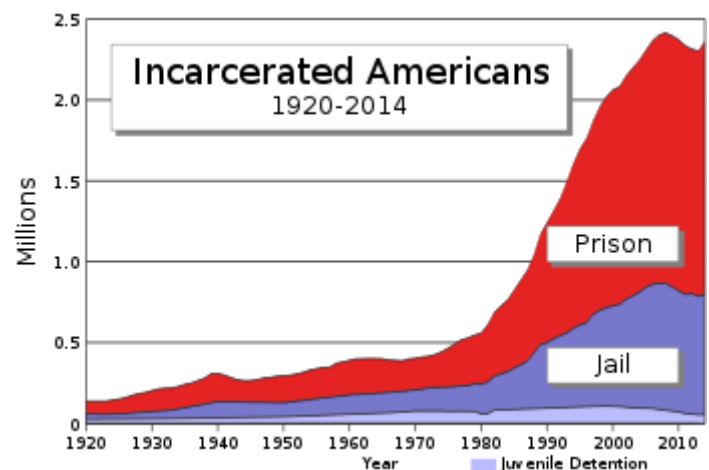
Total U.S. incarceration (prisons and jails) peaked in 2008. Total correctional population peaked in 2007.^[10] If all prisoners are counted (including those juvenile, territorial, U.S. Immigration and Customs Enforcement (ICE) (immigration detention), Indian country, and military), then in 2008 the United States had around 24.7% of the world's 9.8 million prisoners.^{[11][12][13]}

In 2009, the United States had the highest documented incarceration rate in the world, at 754 per 100,000.^{[14][15]} As of December 31, 2010, the International Centre for Prison Studies (ICPS) at King's College London estimated 2,266,832 prisoners from a total population of 310.64 million as of this date (730 per 100,000 in 2010).^[16]

This number comprises local jails with a nominal capacity of 866,782 inmates occupied at 86.4% (June 6, 2010), state prisons with a nominal capacity of approximately 1,140,500 occupied at approximately 115% (December 31, 2010), and federal prisons with a nominal capacity of 126,863 occupied at 136.0% (December 31, 2010). Of this number, 21.5% are pretrial detainees (December 31, 2010), 8.7% are female prisoners (December 31, 2010), 0.4% are juveniles (June 6, 2009), and 5.9% are foreign prisoners (June 30, 2007).^[16]

The imprisonment rate varies widely by state; Louisiana surpasses this by about 100%, but Maine incarcerates at about a fifth this rate. A report released 28 February 2008, indicates that more than 1 in 100 adults in the United States are in prison.^[17]

According to a U.S. Department of Justice report published in 2006, over 7.2 million people were at that time in prison, on probation, or on parole (released from prison with restrictions). That means roughly 1 in every 32 adult Americans are under some sort of criminal justice system control.^{[18][19]}



Total incarceration in the United States by year

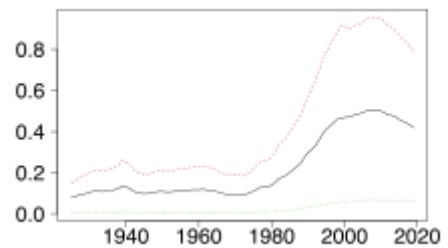
Estimated number of persons supervised by adult correctional systems, by correctional status, 2000-2013

Year	Total correctional population ^a	Community supervision			Incarcerated ^b	
		Total ^a	Probation	Parole	Total ^b	Prison
2000	6,462,000	4,545,100	3,630,500	725,500	1,916,900	1,394,200
2001	6,505,000	4,665,900	3,694,200	731,700	1,962,800	1,404,000
2002	6,751,100	4,740,300	3,995,200	755,100	2,035,500	1,440,100
2003	6,887,000	4,847,500	4,074,800	772,700	2,086,500	1,468,600
2004	6,907,200	4,916,500	4,140,800	775,700	2,136,600	1,497,100
2005	7,055,800	4,946,800	4,162,500	784,300	2,200,400	1,525,900
2006	7,196,800	5,035,200	4,237,800	798,200	2,256,600	1,568,700
2007	7,318,900	5,119,300	4,291,200	828,100	2,296,400	1,596,000
2008	7,314,400	5,085,200	4,270,800	836,200	2,310,300	1,608,300
2009	7,237,100	5,077,900	4,186,200	834,700	2,287,200	1,615,500
2010	7,868,500	4,887,900	4,055,500	840,700	2,279,500	1,613,800
2011	6,996,400	4,814,200	3,971,300	853,900	2,252,500	1,594,000
2012	6,948,500	4,781,300	3,942,800	851,200	2,231,400	1,579,400
2013	6,898,000	4,751,400	3,910,800	853,200	2,220,300	1,574,700

Total US incarceration peaked in 2008. Total correctional population peaked in 2007.^[10]

Growth

In the last quarter of the twentieth century, the incarceration rate in the US increased by a factor of five.^[20] Between the years 2001 and 2012, crime rates (both property and violent crimes) have declined 22% after already falling 30% in years prior between 1991 and 2001.^[21] As of 2012, there are 710 people per every 100,000 U.S. residents in the United States that are imprisoned in either local jails, state prisons, federal prisons, and privately operated facilities.^[21] This corresponds to incarcerating a number close to a quarter of the prison population in the entire world.^{[22][23]}



U.S. prisoners (excluding jails) as a percent of the population [male (dashed red)], combined (solid black)], female (dotted green)

The Bureau of Justice Statistics has released a study which finds that, despite the total number of prisoners incarcerated for drug-related offenses increasing by 57,000 between 1997 and 2004, the proportion of drug offenders to total prisoners in State prison populations stayed steady at 21%. The percentage of Federal prisoners serving time for drug offenses declined from 63% in 1997 to 55% in that same period.^[24] In the twenty-five years since the passage of the Anti-Drug Abuse Act of 1986, the United States penal population rose from around 300,000 to more than two million.^[25] Between 1986 and 1991, African-American women's incarceration in state prisons for drug offenses increased by 828 percent.^[26]

In 2009, the U.S. Department of Justice announced that the growth rate of the state prison population had fallen to its lowest since 2006, but it still had a 0.2% growth-rate compared to the total U.S. prison population.^[27] The California state prison system population fell in 2009, the first year that populations had fallen in 38 years.^[28]

When looking at specific populations within the criminal justice system the growth rates are vastly different. In 1977, there were just slightly more than eleven thousand incarcerated women. By 2004, the number of women under state or federal prison had increased by 757 percent, to more than 111,000, and the percentage of women in prison has increased every year, at roughly double the rate of men, since 2000.^[29] The rate of incarcerated women has expanded at about 4.6% annually between 1995 and 2005 with women now accounting for 7% of the population in state and federal prisons.

Comparison with other countries

Comparing some countries with similar percentages of immigrants, Germany has an incarceration rate of 76 per 100,000 population (as of 2014),^[30] Italy is 85 per 100,000 (as of 2015),^[31] and Saudi Arabia is 161 per 100,000 (as of 2013).^[32] Comparing other countries with a zero tolerance policy for illegal drugs, the rate of Russia is 455 per 100,000 (as of 2015),^[33] Kazakhstan is 275 per 100,000 (as of 2015),^[34] Singapore is 220 per 100,000 (as of 2014),^[35] and Sweden is 60 per 100,000 (as of 2014).^[36]

Causes

A 2014 report by the National Research Council identified two main causes of the increase in the United States' incarceration rate over the previous 40 years: longer prison sentences and increases in the likelihood of imprisonment. The same report found that longer prison sentences were the main driver of increasing incarceration rates since 1990.^[38]

Increased sentencing laws



Felony Sentences in State Courts, study by the United States Department of Justice.

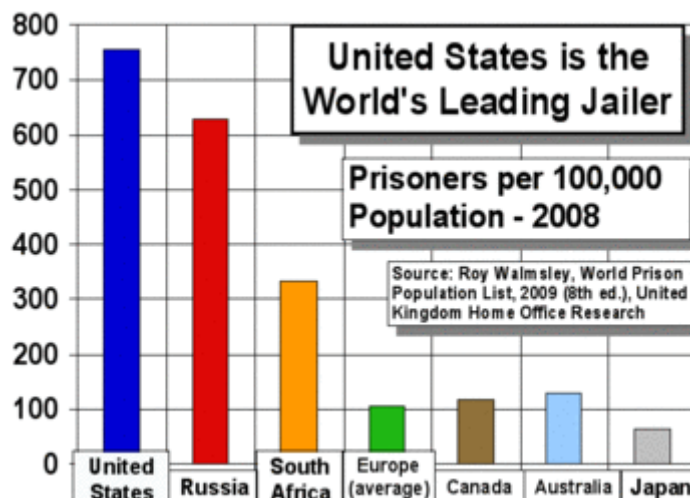
longer causes the total rate to become higher. To give an example, the average burglary sentence in the United States is 16 months, compared to 5 months in Canada and 7 months in England.^[39]

Looking at reasons for imprisonment will further clarify why the incarceration rate and length of sentences are so high. The practice of imposing longer prison sentences on repeat offenders is common in many countries but the three-strikes laws in the U.S. with mandatory 25 year imprisonment — implemented in many states in the 1990s — are statutes enacted by state governments in the United States which mandate state courts to impose harsher sentences on habitual offenders who are previously convicted of two prior serious criminal offenses and then commit a third.

The Violent Crime Control and Law Enforcement Act of 1994 may have had a minor effect on mass incarceration.^[40]

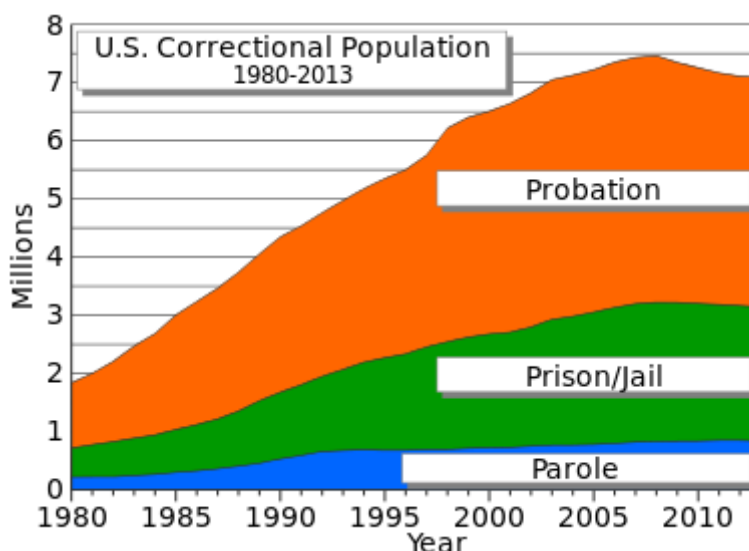
Economic and age contributions

Crime rates in low-income areas are much higher than in middle to high class areas. As a result, Incarceration rates in low-income areas are much higher than in wealthier areas due to these high crime rates.^[41] When the incarcerated or criminal is a youth, there is a significant impact on the individual and rippling effects on entire communities. Social capital is lost when an individual is incarcerated. How much social capital is lost is hard to accurately estimate, however Aizer and Doyle found a strong positive



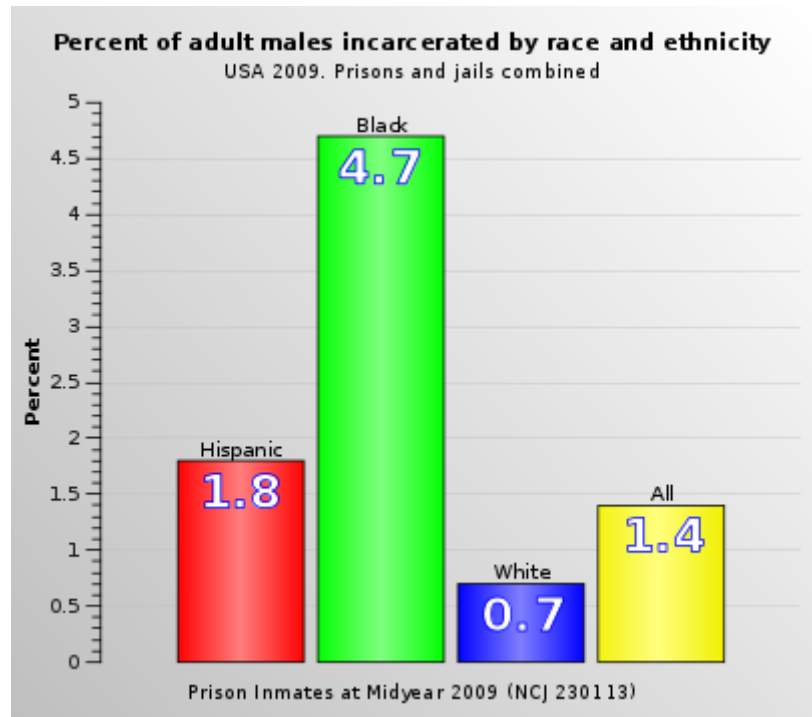
The stats source is the World Prison Population List, 8th edition. Prisoners per 100,000 population.^[12]

Even though there are other countries that commit more inmates to prison annually, the fact that the United States keeps their prisoners



Correctional populations in the United States 1980–2013

correlation between lower income as an adult if an individual is incarcerated in their youth in comparison to those who are not incarcerated.^[42] 63 percent to 66 percent of those involved in crimes are under the age of thirty.^[41] People incarcerated at a younger age lose the capability to invest in themselves and in their communities. Their children and families become susceptible to financial burden preventing them from escaping low-income communities. This contributes to the recurring cycle of poverty that is positively correlated with incarceration.^[43] Poverty rates have not been curbed despite steady economic growth. Poverty is not the sole dependent variable for increasing incarceration rates. Incarceration leads to more incarceration by putting families and communities at a dynamic social disadvantage.^[44]



2009. Percent of adult males incarcerated by race and ethnicity.^[37]

Drug sentencing laws

The "War on Drugs" is a policy that was initiated by Richard Nixon with the Comprehensive Drug Abuse Prevention and Control Act of 1970 and vigorously pursued by Ronald Reagan.^[45] By 2010, drug offenders in federal prison had increased to 500,000 per year, up from 41,000 in 1985. According to Michelle Alexander, drug related charges accounted for more than half the rise in state prisoners between 1985 and 2000. 31 million people have been arrested on drug related charges, approximately 1 in 10 Americans.^{[46][47]} In contrast, John Pfaff of Fordham Law School has accused Alexander of exaggerating the influence of the War on Drugs on the rise in the United States' incarceration rate: according to him, the percent of state prisoners whose primary offense was drug-related peaked at 22% in 1990.^[48] The Brookings Institution reconciles the differences between Alexander and Pfaff by explaining two ways to look at the prison population as it relates to drug crimes, concluding "The picture is clear: Drug crimes have been the predominant reason for new admissions into state and federal prisons in recent decades" and "rolling back the war on drugs would not, as Pfaff and Urban Institute scholars maintain, totally solve the problem of mass incarceration, but it could help a great deal, by reducing exposure to prison."^[49]

After the passage of Reagan's Anti-Drug Abuse Act in 1986, incarceration for non-violent offenses dramatically increased. The Act imposed the same five-year mandatory sentence on those with convictions involving crack as on those possessing 100 times as much powder cocaine.^{[45][50]} This had a disproportionate effect on low-level street dealers and users of crack, who were more commonly poor blacks, Latinos, the young, and women.^[51]

Courts were given more discretion in sentencing by the Kimbrough v. United States (2007) decision, and the disparity was decreased to 18:1 by the Fair Sentencing Act of 2010.^[52] As of 2006, 49.3% of state prisoners, or 656,000 individuals, were incarcerated for non-violent crimes. As of 2008, 90.7% of federal prisoners, or 165,457 individuals, were incarcerated for non-violent offenses.^[11]

By 2003, 58% of all women in federal prison were convicted of drug offenses.^[53] Black and Hispanic women in particular have been disproportionately affected by the War on Drugs. Since 1986, incarceration rates have risen by 400% for women of all races, while rates for Black women have risen by 800%.^[54] Formerly incarcerated Black women are also most negatively impacted by the collateral legal consequences of conviction.^[55]

According to the American Civil Liberties Union, "Even when women have minimal or no involvement in the drug trade, they are increasingly caught in the ever-widening net cast by current drug laws, through provisions of the criminal law such as those involving conspiracy, accomplice liability, and constructive possession that expand criminal liability to reach partners, relatives and bystanders."^[56]

These new policies also disproportionately affect African-American women. According to Dorothy E. Roberts, the explanation is that poor women, who are disproportionately black, are more likely to be placed under constant supervision by the State in order to receive social services.^[57] They are then more likely to be caught by officials who are instructed to look specifically for drug offenses. Roberts argues that the criminal justice system's creation of new crimes has a direct effect on the number of women, especially black women, who then become incarcerated.

Racialization

One of the first laws in the U.S. against drugs was the Opium Exclusion Act of 1909. It prohibited the smoking of opium, which was ingested but not smoked by a substantial portion of Caucasian housewives in America. It was smoked mainly by Asian American immigrants coming to build the railroads. These immigrants were targeted with anti-Asian sentiment, as many voters believed they were losing jobs to Asian immigrants.

Disproportional incarceration of black people

Currently, the U.S. is at its highest rate of imprisonment in history,^[58] with young Black men experiencing the highest levels of incarceration. One out of every 15 people imprisoned across the world is a Black American incarcerated in the United States.^[59] A 2004 study reported that the majority of people sentenced to prison in the United States are Black, and almost one-third of Black men in their twenties are either on parole, on probation, or in prison.^[60] These disproportionate levels of imprisonment have made incarceration a normalized occurrence for African-American communities. This has caused a distrust from Black individuals towards aspects of the legal system such as police, courts, and heavy sentences.^[60] In 2011, more than 580,000 Black men and women were in state or federal prison.^[61] Black men and women are imprisoned at higher rates compared to all other age groups, with the highest rate being Black men aged 25 to 39. In 2001, almost 17% of Black men had previously been imprisoned in comparison to 2.6% of White men. By the end of 2002, of the two million inmates of the U.S. incarceration system, Black men surpassed the number of White men (586,700 to 436,800 respectively of inmates with sentences more than one year).^[60] In the same year, there were also more Black women behind bars than White women (36,000 to 35,400). African-Americans are about eight times more likely to be imprisoned than Whites. The Sentencing Project, a Washington, D.C.-based non-profit organization, released in 1990 that almost one in four Black men in the U.S. between the ages of 20 and 29 were under some degree of control by the criminal justice system. In 1995, the organization announced that the rate had increased to one in three. In the same year, the non-profit stated that more than half of young Black men were then under criminal supervision in both D.C. and Baltimore. In addition, African-American women are the largest growing incarcerated population.

The War on Drugs plays a role in the disproportionate amount of incarcerated African-Americans.^[60] Despite a general decline in crime, the massive increase in new inmates due to drug offenses ensured historically high incarceration rates during the 1990s and beyond, with New York City serving as an example. Drug-related arrests continued to increase in the city despite a near 50% drop in felony crimes. While White individuals have a higher rate of drug use, 60% of people imprisoned for drug charges in 1998 were Black. Drug crimes constituted 27% of the increase in the number of Black state prisoners in the 1990s, while Whites experienced a 14% increase. The rise in African-American imprisonment as a result of newer drug crimes has been justified for its alleged societal benefits. Law officials and advocates of these policies argue that targeting underserved, primarily inner-city neighborhoods is appropriate because these areas see the more harmful and violent effects of drug use. These same individuals further point to the negative effects drug distribution has on these areas to support the inequity in how crimes involving, for example, powdered cocaine can be treated with less severity than crack cocaine. This ideology results in a greater number of arrests of poor, inner-city Black individuals.

A significant contributing factor to these figures are the racially and economically segregated neighborhoods that account for the majority of the Black prison population. These neighborhoods are normally impoverished and possess a high minority population. For example, as many as one in eight adult males who inhabit these urban areas is sent to prison each year, and one in four of these men is in prison on any given day. A 1992 study revealed that 72% of all New York State's prisoners came from only 7 of New York City's 55 community districts. Many recently released individuals return to the area they lived in prior to incarceration. Also in New York City, rates of incarceration stayed the same or grew in 1996 in neighborhoods that had the highest rates in 1990. Additionally, in these same neighborhoods, there was a stronger police presence and parole surveillance despite a period of a general decline in crime.

Finding employment post-release is a significant struggle for African-Americans.^[58] American sociologist Devah Pager performed a study to prove this. She assembled pairs of fake job seekers to find jobs with résumés that portrayed the applicant had a criminal record. The findings indicated that the presence of a criminal record reduced callbacks by approximately 50%. This was more common for African-Americans than for Whites.

Prison privatization

In the 1980s, the rising number of people incarcerated as a result of the War on Drugs and the wave of privatization that occurred under the Reagan Administration saw the emergence of the for-profit prison industry. Although modern private prisons did not exist in the US prior to the 1980s,^{[62][63][64]} the concept of private prisons can be found within the United States as early as the 1800s.^{[65][66]} In 1844, Louisiana privatized its penitentiary when it allowed a private company to run the facility as a factory where prisoners were used to manufacture clothing.^{[65][66]}

In a 2011 report by the ACLU, it is claimed that the rise of the for-profit prison industry is a "major contributor" to "mass incarceration," along with bloated state budgets.^[67] Louisiana, for example, has the highest rate of incarceration in the world with the majority of its prisoners being housed in privatized, for-profit facilities. Such institutions could face bankruptcy without a steady influx of prisoners.^[68] A 2013 Bloomberg report states that in the past decade the number of inmates in for-profit prisons throughout the U.S. rose 44 percent.^[69]

Corporations who operate prisons, such as CoreCivic (formerly the Corrections Corporation of America) and The GEO Group, spend significant amounts of money lobbying the federal government along with state governments.^[67] The two aforementioned companies, the largest in the industry, have been contributors to the American Legislative Exchange Council (ALEC), which seeks to expand the privatization of corrections and lobbies for policies that would increase incarceration, such as three-strike

laws and "truth-in-sentencing" legislation.^{[70][71][72][73][74][75]} Prison companies also sign contracts with states that guarantee at least 90 percent of prison beds be filled. If these "lockup quotas" aren't met, the state must reimburse the prison company for the unused beds. Prison companies use the profits to expand and put pressure on lawmakers to incarcerate a certain number of people.^{[76][77]} This influence on the government by the private prison industry has been referred to as the Prison-industrial complex.^[72]

The industry is well aware of what reduced crime rates could mean to their bottom line. This from the CCA's SEC report in 2010:

Our growth ... depends on a number of factors we cannot control, including crime rates ... [R]eductions in crime rates ... could lead to reductions in arrests, convictions and sentences requiring incarceration at correctional facilities.^[67]

In January 2021, U.S. President Joe Biden signed an executive order directing the Department of Justice (DOJ) to begin phasing out its contracts with private federal prisons.^[78]

As of March 2021, the private prison population of the United States has seen a 16% decline since reaching its peak in 2012 with 137,000 people incarcerated.^[79] According to a March 2021 report released by The Sentencing Project, 115,428 people were incarcerated in private prisons in the US, representing 8% of the total state and federal prison population.^[79]

Editorial policies of major media

Gallup polling since 1989 has found that in most years in which there was a decline in the U.S. crime rate, a majority of Americans said that violent crime was getting worse.^{[80][81][82]}

A substantial body of research claims that incarceration rates are primarily a function of media editorial policies, largely unrelated to the actual crime rate. *Constructing Crime: Perspectives on Making News and Social Problems* is a book collecting together papers on this theme.^[83] The researchers say that the jump in incarceration rate from 0.1% to 0.5% of the United States population from 1975 to 2000 (documented in the figure above) was driven by changes in the editorial policies of the mainstream commercial media and is unrelated to any actual changes in crime. Media consolidation reduced competition on content. That allowed media company executives to maintain substantially the same audience while slashing budgets for investigative journalism and filling the space from the police blotter, which tended to increase and stabilize advertising revenue. It is safer, easier and cheaper to write about crimes committed by poor people than the wealthy. Poor people can be libeled with impunity, but major advertisers can materially impact the profitability of a commercial media organization by reducing their purchases of advertising space with that organization.

News media thrive on feeding frenzies (such as missing white women) because they tend to reduce production costs while simultaneously building an audience interested in the latest development in a particular story. It takes a long time for a reporter to learn enough to write intelligently about a specific issue. Once a reporter has achieved that level of knowledge, it is easier to write subsequent stories. However, major advertisers have been known to spend their advertising budgets through different channels when they dislike the editorial policies. Therefore, a media feeding frenzy focusing on an issue of concern to an advertiser may reduce revenue and profits.^[84]

Sacco described how "competing news organizations responded to each other's coverage [while] the police, in their role as gatekeepers of crime news, reacted to the increased media interest by making available more stories that reflected and reinforced" a particular theme. "[T]he dynamics of competitive

journalism created a media feeding frenzy that found news workers 'snatching at shocking numbers' and 'smothering reports of stable or decreasing use under more ominous headlines.'"^[85]

The reasons cited above for increased incarcerations (US racial demographics, Increased sentencing laws, and Drug sentencing laws) have been described as consequences of the shift in editorial policies of the mainstream media.^[86]

Additionally, media coverage has been proven to have a profound impact on criminal sentencing. A study conducted found that the more media attention a criminal case is given, the greater the incentive for prosecutors and judges to pursue harsher sentences.^[87] This is directly linked to the enormous increase in media coverage of crime over the past two decades. While crime decreased by 8% between 1992 and 2002, news reports on crime increased by 800% and the average prison sentence length increased by 2,000% for all crimes. Less media coverage means a greater chance of a lighter sentence or that the defendant may avoid prison time entirely.

Citizenship statistics

Inmate citizenship statistics, which are updated monthly by the Federal Bureau of Prisons, lists the following statistics for July 2021: 83.67% of Federal inmates are U.S. citizens; 9.3% are citizens of Mexico, and the next three countries—Colombia, Cuba, and the Dominican Republic, contribute less than 1% each; 4.9% have other or unknown citizenship. The Bureau did not state how many had come to the U.S. legally.^[88]

See also

- [Comparison of United States incarceration rate with other countries](#)
- [Felony disenfranchisement in the United States](#)
- [Incarceration in the United States](#)
- [List of U.S. states by incarceration rate](#)
- [Mass incarceration](#)
- [Mentally ill people in United States jails and prisons](#)
- [Prison–industrial complex](#)
- [Race and the War on Drugs](#)
- [Youth incarceration in the United States](#)
- [Decarceration in the United States](#)

Notes

1. [US Department of Justice, Oct. 22, 2020 \(https://www.bjs.gov/content/pub/press/p19_pr.pdf\)](https://www.bjs.gov/content/pub/press/p19_pr.pdf)
2. Kang-Brown, Jacob; Montagnet, Chase; Heiss, Jasmine (January 2021). ["People in Jail and Prison in 2020" \(https://www.vera.org/downloads/publications/people-in-jail-and-prison-in-2020.pdf\) \(PDF\).](https://www.vera.org/downloads/publications/people-in-jail-and-prison-in-2020.pdf)
3. "[T]he [world population](#) ...was estimated to have reached 7,800,000,000 people as of March 2020." Meanwhile, ["The United States](#) had an official resident population of 331,449,281 on April 1, 2020", according to the Wikipedia articles accessed 2021-09-26. 331.448/7900 = 0.042.

4. Roy Walmsley (September 1, 2018), *World Prison Population List, 12th edition* (https://www.prisonstudies.org/sites/default/files/resources/downloads/wppl_12.pdf) (PDF) (12th ed.), Wikidata Q108701677 Table 7, p. 17, gives numbers for "World prison population levels" including separate numbers for "Americas" and "[Americas] without U.S.A." for 2000 and 2020. Subtracting "[Americas] without U.S.A." from "Americas" gives U.S.A. Dividing those numbers by the World total gives 22 percent for 2000, the previous number used in this article prior to modifying this reference to cite the 12th edition, and 20 percent for 2020.
5. Direct expenditures by justice function, 1982-2007 (billions of dollars) (<https://web.archive.org/web/20120101181331/http://bjs.ojp.usdoj.gov/content/glance/tables/exptyptab.cfm>). Inflation adjusted to 2007 dollars. U.S. Bureau of Justice Statistics (BJS). Retrieved 1 Jan 2012 by the Internet Archive. See BJS timeline graph based on the data (<https://web.archive.org/web/20120101082347/http://bjs.ojp.usdoj.gov/content/glance/exptytp.cfm>).
6. Justice Expenditures and Employment, FY 1982-2007 - Statistical Tables (<http://www.bjs.gov/index.cfm?ty=pbdetail&iid=2192>) (NCJ 236218). Published December 2011. U.S. Bureau of Justice Statistics (BJS). By Tracey Kyckelhahn, Ph.D., BJS statistician. See table 2 of the PDF (<http://www.bjs.gov/content/pub/pdf/jee8207st.pdf>). "Total justice expenditures, by justice function, FY 1982–2007 (real dollars)". A total of around \$74 billion for corrections in 2007.
7. "Justice Expenditures and Employment in the United States, 2017" (<https://bjs.ojp.gov/library/publications/justice-expenditures-and-employment-united-states-2017>). Bureau of Justice Statistics. Retrieved July 27, 2021.
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